

Local Law

When visiting other countries, it is customary to pay close attention to the local laws that apply, Indonesia is no exception. As a country of diversity with an abundance of different cultures, laws, and customs to honour, respect and comply with, travellers who plan to visit Indonesia must follow these local laws & customs to avoid any trouble or mishaps.

DRUGS

What is the penalty for drug possession and trafficking in Indonesia?

Like in many countries, Indonesia has Capital Punishments for Possession and Trafficking of illegal drugs.

Possession is punishable by 4 to 12 years of imprisonment. There is also IDR 800 million to 8 billion (US\$89,600 to US\$896,000) worth of fines. If the drugs exceed 1 kilogram (for raw drugs like marijuana) or 5 grams (for processed drugs like heroin and cocaine), a maximum punishment of life imprisonment may be imposed.

Trafficking is punishable by 5 to 15 years of imprisonment and fines of IDR one billion to ten billion (US\$112,000 to US\$1.2 million). If the volume of drugs exceeds 1 kilogram (for raw drugs) or 5 grams (for processed drugs), the death penalty may be imposed.

SMOKING

Is Smoking Allowed in Indonesia?

Smoking is prohibited in public places, such as Healthcare Facilities, Educational Facilities, and Places of Worship. Smoking is also prohibited in Public Transport. Children's Outdoor or Indoor Facilities are also a smoke-free zone. Designated smoking areas are a must in other types of public places and office buildings.

How Many Cigarettes Can I Bring to Indonesia?

Travellers could bring a maximum of 200 cigarettes, 50 cigars or 100 grams of tobacco and a reasonable amount of perfume per adult.

DRINKING

Is alcohol legal in Indonesia?

As a country with Muslims as the majority, alcohol drinking is prohibited by the laws of the religion and frowned upon. However, since Indonesia is a country with diverse cultures and religions, currently there are no alcohol bans being enforced in Indonesia, with the exception of Aceh.

Drinking is also prohibited in most Public Places such as Worship Places, Workplaces, Schools, Malls, Supermarkets, Minimarkets, Outdoor/Indoor Public Space, and other places where there are a lot of people/crowd in the area. Also prohibited, driving while under the influence of alcohol. Don't drink and drive!

What is the drinking age in Indonesia?

The legal age for drinking in Indonesia is 21 years old. Those who are caught drinking outside the legal age will face serious punishment or charges from the authorities.

OVERSTAYING

What Happens if You Overstayed in Indonesia?

Indonesia's law on immigration for travellers who overstay is no more than 60 days. Those who overstay within the 60 days period will have to pay a daily fine of IDR up to 1 million per day. Those who overstayed more than 60 days will face deportation and possible blacklisting.

DRIVING

Can Foreigners Drive in Indonesia?

Foreigners can drive using an international driving permit that has been issued in Indonesia, as well as a driver's license from the individual's home country. Alternatively, foreigners can have the international driving permit issued in their home country before they leave, but this may need to be endorsed by the Indonesian licensing office in Jakarta once they arrive.

What is the Age Limit to Drive in Indonesia?

The age limit to drive in Indonesia after obtaining the Indonesian driving license issued by the Indonesian National Police (Polri) is 17 years old.

What is the speed limit in Indonesia?

In Indonesia, people drive on the left-hand side of the road, and standard international driving laws apply. The speed limit is 50kph in urban areas in Indonesia, and 100kph on a motorway, but the only proper motorways in the country are in Java.

GAMBLING

Is Gambling Legal in Indonesia?

Gambling is prohibited in Indonesia, it is considered completely illegal for both locals and foreigners. There are no proper casinos in the country, and those who practice gambling may find severe punishments by authorities and thrown to jail.

WHAT IS THE EMERGENCY HOTLINE IN INDONESIA?

Indonesia has different systems for landlines and mobile phones: landlines use area codes, while mobile phones do not. For landline area codes, the digit "0" is added in front when dialling domestic long distance from within Indonesia, but is always omitted when calling from abroad. Here are some important numbers/hotline for Police Assistance in case you need assistance on a matter:

Emergency Numbers

- Police/General Emergencies: 110 or 112(From Satellite and Mobile Phones)
- Ambulance and Medical Emergencies: 118 or 119
- Firefighter: 113
- Search and Rescue (BASARNAS): 115
- Natural Disaster Assistance: 129

Useful Numbers:

International Phone Number Information: 102

Local Phone Number Information: 108

Domestic Call Operator: 100 and 106

International Call Operators: 101 and 107

Tourism Information:

Bureau of Public Communication of the Ministry of Tourism: +62 21 3838899

Important note for foreigners visiting Indonesia, be sure to carry your passport with you at all times as a form of identification as a precaution measures. Chances are you won't need it, but there is always a chance that you may be required to do so.

Embassies

As Indonesia's capital city, most foreign diplomatic missions reside in Jakarta. Most of the embassies are situated in the Menteng area and M.H. Thamrin Avenue in Central Jakarta, and also Jalan Jenderal Sudirman, Kuningan and Mega Kuningan area in South Jakarta. Apart from Jakarta, a number of consulates are also situated in other major cities of Indonesia, most preferably Bali as one of Indonesia's favorite tourist destinations.

For travelers visiting cities outside of Jakarta and Bali and in need of assistance from your home country's representative, contact the Jakarta based embassy for information on embassies or consulates in other cities in Indonesia.

Staying Safe in Indonesia

How do I make calls in Indonesia using a landline?

Telephone numbers in Indonesia have different systems for landlines and mobile phones: landlines use area codes, while mobile phones do not. For landline area codes, the digit "0" is added in front when dialing domestic long distance from within Indonesia, but is always omitted when calling from abroad. Instead, callers would use the Indonesian country code +62, followed by the area code, without the "0". To make a phone call to Indonesia from abroad via landlines, callers dial +62, followed by the area code and subscriber's number, omitting the '0'. For calls to mobile wireless phones (GSM) from abroad, callers dial +62, followed by the subscriber's number, omitting the '0'.

What are the main emergency numbers I need to know?

- Police/General Emergencies: 110 or 112 (From Satellite and Mobile Phones)
- Ambulance and Medical Emergencies: 118 or 119
- Firefighter: 113
- Search and Rescue (BASARNAS): 115
- Natural Disaster Assistance: 129
- Useful Numbers:
- International Phone Number Information: 102
- Local Phone Number Information: 108
- Domestic Call Operator: 100 and 106
- International Call Operators: 101 and 107

Tourism Information:

- Bureau of Public Communication of the Ministry of Tourism: +62 21 3838899

Weather, Climate & Seasons

What is the weather like in Indonesia?

The climate of Indonesia is almost entirely tropical. The uniformly warm waters that make up 81% of Indonesia's area ensures that temperatures on land remain fairly constant, with the coastal plains averaging 28 °C, the inland and mountain areas averaging 26 °C, and the higher mountain regions, 23 °C. Temperature varies little from season to season, and Indonesia experiences relatively little change in the length of daylight hours from one season to the next.

Is the weather generally rainy?

The main variable of Indonesia's climate is not temperature or air pressure, but rainfall. The area's relative humidity ranges between 70% and 90%. Although air temperature changes little from season to season or from one region to the next, cooler temperatures prevail at higher elevations. In general, temperatures drop approximately 1°C per 90-meter increase in elevation from sea level with some high-altitude interior mountain regions experiencing night frosts.

Are there different seasons in Indonesia?

Being a tropical country, Indonesia does not have spring, summer, autumn, or winter, instead of just the two seasons of Rainy and Dry, both of which are relative. While there is significant regional variation, in most of the country (including Java and Bali) the dry season is April to October, while the wet season is November to March. However, global warming has made the seasons less predictable.

Currency

What is the currency of Indonesia?

The official currency of Indonesia is Rupiah which is Issued and controlled by the Bank of Indonesia. The currency code for Rupiahs is IDR, and the currency symbol is Rp. By law,

all transactions are required to be conducted in rupiah, and information on the daily exchange rate can be found in newspapers or from the internet and online apps. Credit cards are widely accepted in hotels, large restaurants, and large stores.

Indonesian banknotes come in denominations of IDR1000, IDR2000, IDR5000, IDR10000, IDR20000, IDR50000, and IDR100000. Coins in circulation include IDR1000, IDR500, IDR200, IDR100, and IDR50.

Where can I buy and exchange currency?

You can exchange foreign currency in major cities throughout the archipelago at banks and money changers. Most tourists' resorts have money changer facilities; however, if you are traveling to more remote areas it is advisable to exchange your money beforehand. If you need a large amount of foreign currency, and you don't have a foreign currency account at your bank, it is best to order the money the day before. Local banks keep a limited amount of foreign currency in their smaller branches.

Are ATMs easily accessible?

ATMs on the international Plus/Cirrus or Alto networks are common in all major Indonesian cities and tourist destinations. Limitation withdrawal is depending on your respective home bank. Machines are loaded with IDR50,000 denomination notes or IDR100,000 denomination notes, as indicated on the machine; however keep in mind that the bigger notes can be harder to split, especially in rural non-tourist areas. It is also best to withdraw some money from an ATM in major cities before venturing onto more secluded destinations.

Indonesia Updates Visa Classification System: Understanding the New Visa Indexes

Indonesia has updated its visa classification system under the Decree of the Minister of Immigration and Corrections of the Republic of Indonesia Number M.IP-08.GR.01.01 of 2025 concerning Visa Classification.

The updated system introduces new visa indexes and clarifies the activities permitted under each visa category. Travelers are encouraged to understand the purpose of their visa before entering Indonesia, as engaging in activities outside the authorized scope may result in immigration sanctions.

Below are several examples of visa categories introduced under the updated classification system.

Examples of New Visa Indexes Under Indonesia's Updated Visa Classification

C5A Content Creator Visit Visa

This visa is intended for foreign nationals who create social media content while visiting Indonesia.

Permitted activities include:

- Creating social media content
- Tourism activities
- Visiting friends and family
- Purchasing goods for personal use

Activities not permitted include:

- Selling goods or services in Indonesia
- Receiving salaries, wages, or compensation from Indonesian individuals or companies
- Conducting journalistic or filmmaking activities that require special permits

C6 Social Activities Visit Visa

This visa is intended for foreign nationals participating in social, humanitarian, or volunteer activities.

Permitted activities include:

- Social work
- Humanitarian aid activities
- Volunteer programs
- Tourism and family visits

Activities not permitted include:

- Selling goods or services
- Receiving salaries or compensation from Indonesian entities
- Conducting activities outside the approved social purpose

E33G Remote Worker Limited Stay Visa

This visa is intended for foreign nationals employed by companies located outside Indonesia who perform their work remotely while staying in Indonesia.

Permitted activities include:

- Working remotely for overseas employers
- Living in Indonesia while conducting overseas-based work
- Bringing eligible family members according to immigration regulations
- Tourism and personal travel activities

Activities not permitted include:

- Working for Indonesian companies without the appropriate permit
- Selling goods or services in Indonesia
- Conducting activities beyond the approved visa purpose
- Remaining in Indonesia after the visa or stay permit has expired

Consequences of Visa Violations

Foreign nationals who violate immigration regulations (overstaying, violating Indonesian laws, Conducting activities beyond the approved visa purpose) may be subject to administrative or legal sanctions, including:

- Administrative fines
- Detention
- Deportation
- Blacklisting from re-entering Indonesia
- Other legal actions in accordance with Indonesian law

Obligations of All Visa Holders

All foreign visitors are expected to:

- Comply with Indonesian laws and regulations
- Respect local customs, traditions, and culture
- Maintain sufficient financial means during their stay in Indonesia
- Follow the conditions attached to their visa category

Travel responsibly and ensure that your activities always match the purpose of your visa.

Note that this regulation is dynamic and can be changed from time to time, so that travelers need to recheck and confirm before planning their future journey.

Looking for a complete list of Indonesian visa categories and requirements?

Indonesia's visa regulations continue to evolve, and additional visa categories may be available depending on your purpose of visit.

For the latest and most comprehensive information on Indonesian visas, please visit the [official Directorate General of Immigration website](#).

History

The history of Indonesia can be marked as the dawn of mankind since it is where the remains of the early man were unearthed. During the ancient age of kingdoms and empires, Indonesia saw the rise of the great empires that ruled over almost all of South-East Asia and regarded to play a key role in the history of the region. After gaining independence from foreign colonization and the wave of both World Wars, Indonesia emerged as one united country and continued to thrive amongst the top nations of the world to this very day.

When was the dawn of mankind in Indonesia?

Fossilized remains of Homo erectus and his tools, popularly known as the "Java Man" found in the archaeological site of Sangiran in Central Java, suggested that the Indonesian archipelago was already inhabited by "the early man" at least since 1.5 million years ago. Recently, the fossil of Homo floresiensis or nicknamed as 'hobbit man' was discovered in Liang Bua, Flores Island and also believed to be one of the ancestors of modern humans.

What happened during the age of Kings and Sultans?

Chinese chronicles mention that trade between India, China and the islands within what today is the Indonesian Archipelago was already thriving since the first century AD. The powerful maritime empire of Srivijaya in southern Sumatra that ruled over the Sumatra seas and the Malacca Straits from the 7th to the 13th century was the centre for Buddhism learning and famous for its wealth. In the 8th- 9th century, the Sailendra Dynasty of the Mataram kingdom in Central Java built the magnificent Buddhist Borobudur temple in Central Java and followed by the construction of the Hindu Temple Prambanan.

From 1294 to the 15th century the powerful Majapahit Kingdom in East Java held suzerainty over a large part of this archipelago. Meanwhile, small and large sultanates thrived on many islands of the archipelago, from Sumatra to Java and Bali, to Kalimantan, Sulawesi, Ternate and the Moluccas, especially following the arrival of Islam in the 13th Century.

What was the Colonial Era like?

Following the arrival of Marco polo in Sumatra, successive waves of Europeans—the Portuguese, Spanish, Dutch and British—sought to dominate the spice trade at its sources which is at the Moluccas or Maluku Islands of Indonesia began in the 16th century. In 1596 the first Dutch vessels anchored at the shores of West Java. Over the next three centuries, the Dutch gradually colonized this archipelago until it became known as the Dutch East Indies.

The Emergence of Indonesia and the Declaration of Independence

Revolt against the oppressing colonizers soon built up throughout the country. The Indonesian youth, in their Youth Pledge of 1928 vowed together to build “One Country, One Nation and One Language: Indonesia”, regardless of race, religion, language or ethnic background in the territory then known as the Dutch East Indies.

Finally, on the 17th of August 1945, after the defeat of the Japanese in the Second World War, the Indonesian people declared their Independence through their leaders Soekarno and Hatta. Freedom, however, was not easily granted. Only after years of bloody fighting did the Dutch government finally relent, officially recognizing Indonesia's Independence in 1950.

Language

What is the main language of Indonesia?

Bahasa Indonesia is the national and official language of Indonesia and is used in the entire country. It is the language of official communication, taught in schools and used for broadcast in electronic and digital media. Most Indonesians also have their own ethnic language and dialect, with the most widely spoken being Javanese and Sundanese. Some ethnic Chinese communities continue to speak various Chinese dialects, most notably Hokkien in Medan and Teochew in Pontianak.

Do people speak or understand English?

English is not widely spoken, however, an acceptable level of English can be understood in a number of major cities and tourists' destinations including Bali, Batam, Jakarta, Bandung, Surabaya, and Yogyakarta. Moreover, most hotel and airline staff can also communicate in English on a basic to moderate level.

What are some common phrases in Bahasa that can help me?

Indonesian pronunciation is relatively easy to master. Each letter always represents the same sound and most letters are pronounced the same as their English counterparts. The following are examples of some of the common phrases in Bahasa Indonesia that can be useful in conversation:

- Good Morning = Selamat Pagi
- Good Day = Selamat Siang
- Good Afternoon = Selamat Sore
- Good Evening/Good Night = Selamat Malam
- Goodbye = Selamat Tinggal
- How are you? = Apa Kabar
- I'm Fine/Good/Great = Baik-baik (as an answer to *Apa Kabar*)
- Excuse me = Permisi
- Sorry = Maaf
- Please = Silahkan
- Help! = Tolong!
- Thank You = Terima Kasih
- You're Welcome = Terima kasih Kembali
- Yes = Ya
- Tidak = No
- Mr/Sir = Bapak
- Ms/Ms/Madam = Ibu
- Miss = Nona
- How much/many = Berapa
- How much is it (price)? = Berapa Harganya?
- Where is... = Dimana....
- How to get There = bagaimana caranya kesana?
- I want... = Saya Mau...
- I don't want... = Saya Tidak Mau.....

All Indonesia App Guide for Travelers Entering Indonesia

Traveling to Indonesia is now easier as arrival reporting and clearance requirements have been digitized. To help travelers enjoy a faster, more organized, and efficient entry

experience, the government has introduced **All Indonesia**, an app that travelers can use upon arrival in Indonesia to support the **Customs clearance process**.

This app is highly relevant for both international visitors and Indonesian citizens returning from overseas, as it helps make arrival declarations more practical and convenient.

Read this complete guide so you won't feel confused when going through the arrival process at an international airport or seaport.

What is the All Indonesia App?

All Indonesia is an official app that supports digital arrival reporting, including Customs clearance requirements for travelers. With this app, travelers can complete arrival details and supporting information in a more structured way, helping ensure a smoother inspection process at Indonesia's entry points.

The app is designed for:

- Foreign travelers (international visitors)
- Indonesian citizens (WNI)
- Individuals and groups

Why Should Travelers Use All Indonesia?

Upon arrival in Indonesia, travelers usually go through several steps such as document checks, arrival procedures, and Customs-related processes. In busy airport conditions, manual procedures can create long queues and confusion.

With All Indonesia, travelers can:

- Reduce waiting time by completing their data in advance.
- Ensure their information is saved properly and can be reused for future trips.
- Get clearer navigation through the arrival process, as the flow is prepared digitally.
- Enjoy a faster and more convenient entry experience into Indonesia.

When Should You Fill Out All Indonesia?

Travelers can complete All Indonesia up to 3 days before their arrival date in Indonesia.

This is very helpful so you won't feel rushed when arriving at the airport. In addition, make sure you already have the following final information:

- Passport number
- Flight details
- Arrival schedule
- Travel information

How to Access All Indonesia

To use All Indonesia, travelers can access the official link on this page:

<https://allindonesia.imigrasi.go.id>

The link can be opened via smartphone or laptop. You can also access it while traveling so you are better prepared when landing in Indonesia.

Key Features of All Indonesia That Help Travelers

Here are several features that are especially useful for travelers:

1. Online Arrival Card

All Indonesia allows travelers to fill out the arrival card online without going through a time-consuming manual process.

Benefits include:

- No need to fill it out again on-site.
- Practical for individuals and groups.
- Helps reduce queues.

2. Auto-Fill and Save Data

The app can store important information such as:

- Passport details
- Flight information

So for your next trip, you can complete the form faster using the auto-fill feature.

3. Real-Time Notifications

All Indonesia provides instant notifications in the form of updates or reminders related to the arrival process. This is especially useful if there is information that still needs to be completed.

4. Multilingual Support

The app is available in several languages, including:

- Indonesian
- English
- Mandarin

This feature makes it easier for international travelers to understand instructions and steps.

5. Encrypted Data Protection

You also don't need to worry about your personal data being exposed. The app ensures travelers' personal information is protected through a multi-layer encryption system to keep it secure.

Practical Tips for Travelers When Using All Indonesia

To ensure your arrival process runs smoothly, follow these tips:

- Complete All Indonesia before your departure day—don't wait until you arrive.
- Make sure your passport and flight details are correct (name, passport number, dates).
- Prepare a stable internet connection.
- Save proof of submission or take a screenshot if needed.

All Indonesia is a practical solution for travelers who want to enter Indonesia more easily.

With features such as the online arrival card, automatic data storage, multilingual support,

and real-time notifications, travelers can save time and reduce stress upon arrival at the airport.

If you are planning to travel to Indonesia soon, make sure to access and complete All Indonesia early through the official link:

<https://allindonesia.imigrasi.go.id>

Once your arrival process is complete, it's time to enjoy your trip!

If you would like destination recommendations, itineraries, local culture insights, travel tips, or have other questions about traveling in Indonesia, you can ask MaiA, the official AI Chatbot on indonesia.travel.